For your Intel Mac mini 2012, do it in this order.

1. Install Homebrew

Open Terminal:

/bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL
https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/install.sh)"

Verify:

brew --version

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2. Install Python + Tesseract

brew install python@3.12
brew install tesseract

Verify:

python3 --version
tesseract --version

---

3. Copy the SAM project to the Mac

For example:

~/sam-ticket-server

Copy:

- `app.py`
- `ticket_detector.py`
- `detect_tickets.py`
- `requirements.txt`
- `models/`
- everything needed

Especially:

models/sam_vit_b_01ec64.pth

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4. Create virtual environment

Go to project folder:

cd ~/sam-ticket-server

Create venv:

python3 -m venv .venv

Activate:

source .venv/bin/activate

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5. Upgrade pip

pip install --upgrade pip setuptools wheel

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6. Install PyTorch CPU

For Intel Mac:

pip install torch torchvision

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7. Install project requirements

pip install -r requirements.txt

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8. Set environment variables

export SAM_API_KEY="change-me"
export SAM_DEVICE="cpu"

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9. Start the server

python -m uvicorn app:app --host 0.0.0.0 --port 8000

You should see:

Application startup complete
Uvicorn running on http://0.0.0.0:8000

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10. Test locally on Mac

Open another terminal:

curl http://127.0.0.1:8000/health

Then test image upload:

curl -X POST "http://127.0.0.1:8000/detect-tickets" \
 -H "x-api-key: change-me" \
 -F "image=@/path/to/image.jpeg"

---

11. Make it reachable publicly

Best option:

- Cloudflare Tunnel

Install:

brew install cloudflared

Login:

cloudflared tunnel login

Temporary public tunnel:

cloudflared tunnel --url http://localhost:8000

It will give you a public HTTPS URL like:

https://random-name.trycloudflare.com

Then your Azure/.NET backend can call:

POST https://random-name.trycloudflare.com/detect-tickets